

Wildcats bombard Miners in opener

By STEVE WESTON
Citizen Sportswriter

If University of Arizona's baseball team can finish the way it started, defending its Western Athletic Conference baseball championship will be no problem at all.

Coach Jerry Kindall's Wildcats opened WAC Southern Division action last night with a resounding, 23-4 triumph over Texas-El Paso's Miners before a Hi Corbett Field crowd of 2,087 — the majority of whom weren't around at game's end.

It was never a contest as the Wildcats boosted their season record to 26-6-1 and handed coach Andy Cohen's UTEP team its 10th loss against 15 victories.

"But we don't want them to sneak up on us," Kindall said in the way of a warning about today's day-night doubleheader.

Last year, the Cats crushed the Miners in the first game of a twin bill, 25-3, only to lose the second game, 6-4.

That was one of few losses marring the Cats' record and it had no bearing on the conference race.

Right-hander Ron Bell was to be on the mound for UA 1 p.m. at Wildcat Field and Steve Powers was scheduled to wind up the three-game series for UA at 7:30 tonight at Hi Corbett.

"We have to be ever alert," said third-year coach Kindall.

"They'll play a lot tougher . . . you know they'll make all the big plays. We'll have to be ready all over again."

Ready was hardly an apt word to describe the Cats last night as they whacked out 20 hits, including three doubles, three triples and a home run, in laying waste to six Texas-El Paso pitchers.

Right-hander Craig Gioia, a junior college transfer, had an easy night of it in pitching up his fifth victory against two defeats. Gioia gave up 10 hits, but struck out nine and was effective throughout with nine strikeouts despite the amount of time he had to spend cooling his heels — and right arm — in the dugout between innings.

"It's hard for a pitcher to stay up all the way in a game like that," Kindall observed. "But Craig did a fine job. And he's cemented himself as our No. 1 starter."

UA center fielder Dave Stegman set the pace when he led off the first inning for the Cats with an inside-the-park home run, thoroughly demoralizing UTEP hurler George Landreth, who came in with a 0.85 earned run average.

The Cats toyed with Landreth in the first inning with just two runs, then exploded for eight runs in the second — Mike Gatlin's double driving in two runs.

Landreth had already departed by that time, but the Cats were no more friendly to his successor, Bob Knox, and struck for eight more runs in the third.

From then on, it was a matter of which would come first — the end of the game or sunrise.

UA shortstop Bill Simpson ended up driving home four runs on a sacrifice fly, a single, a fielder's choice, and a triple. Pat O'Sullivan, Stegman and Ken Bolek each furnished the Cats with three RBI's apiece.

Seven Cats had at least two hits each as all but two UA players who appeared in the game hit safely.

Governor launches land access study

FLAGSTAFF — Gov. Raul Castro will appoint a citizens' committee to investigate access problems on state lands.

The promise came during the Arizona Wildlife Federation's 52nd annual convention here today.

Castro said the committee will be composed of ranchers and farmers, plus hunters, hikers and environmentalists.

"Both sides must realize their responsibilities, but the

ranchers must realize they have a responsibility to the public and that the public has a right to enter state land."

Castro said he would not announce his appointment to the Arizona Game and Commission until next week because "more than 150 persons from every corner of the state have applied."

He has not had time to review all the applicants, he said.

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Wildcats 23, Miners 4

UTEP	ab	r	h	bi	Arizona	ab	r	h	bi
Bravo 2b	5	0	0	0	Stegman cf	3	2	3	
Aisup lf	3	1	1	0	Pearsey ph-cf	1	1	1	
Villarreal 3b	4	1	1	0	Bolek rf	4	2	3	
Stringer dh	4	0	0	0	Gatlin lf	4	2	2	
Patt lf	0	0	0	0	Hrmtz pr-lf	0	1	0	
Pennies cf	4	0	2	2	Hessey 3b	2	0	1	
Dinghm lb	4	1	1	0	Rulz pr-3b	2	0	1	
Dav rf	2	0	0	0	Van Hrn lb	4	2	2	
Walsh rf	0	0	0	0	Hostn pr-lb	1	1	0	
Rushing ph	1	1	1	0	Simpson ss	5	3	2	
Dehn c	4	0	3	1	Szcznski dh	4	4	2	
Nance ss	3	0	0	1	Woodside c	3	0	0	
					Lopez c	3	0	0	
					O'Sullivan 2b	2	2	3	
					Russell 2b	2	0	1	
Totals	34	4	9	4	Totals	42	23	20	19

UTEP	000	002	002	—	4
Arizona	288	100	13x	—	23

E — Dehn, Villarreal 2, Woodside.
LOB — UTEP 6, Arizona 10. DP —
UTEP 1, Arizona 1. 2B — Gatlin, O'Sullivan, Bolek. 3B — Dehn, Pennies, Stegman, Pearse, Simpson. HR — Stegman (6). SB — Simpson. SF — Nance, Simpson, Bolek.

	ip	h	r	er	bb	so
Landreth (L, 3-2)	1	4	4	4	2	0
Knox	1/3	3	6	6	4	0
Hilton	1	3	5	2	0	1
Llamas	2/3	2	3	3	0	3
Jannusch	4	7	5	5	2	1
Aisup	2/3	1	0	0	0	1
Gioia (W, 5-2)	9	10	4	4	1	9
HBP — By Landreth (Hessey); by Hilton (Bolek); by Hilton (Gatlin). WP — Llamas, Jannusch. U — Hugenin, Grainger. T — 2:53. A — 2,087.						